

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Grr ... It's not working again!



Learning Outcome

Describe complicated or unusual events in the past through a wider range of B1 language in both work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can ask and offer help with technical problems.
- I can describe a simple technical problem.
- I can talk about what is advisable.

Ask your partner:

- What electronic equipment do you use in your school or office?
- What are some technical problems you might have with this equipment?
- Are you good at solving technical problems? Why or why not?





Let's Explore!

Sally and Janice try to **figure out*** what is wrong with the fax machine.

* To "figure out" means to find out, or to learn.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** Excuse me, Janice? Do you have a minute? Can you help me for a sec?
Janice: Sure, what's the problem?
Sally: The fax machine seems to be making a strange noise. Do you know what to do?
Janice: Did you turn it off and then on again?
Sally: Yes, I did that already.
Janice: Perhaps it's a paper jam somewhere. We ought to check.
Sally: There could be a mechanical problem with the roller.
Janice: You might want to look at the control panel. Does it say anything?
Sally: No, there is no error message. The network buttons are correct.
Janice: I'm not sure where the instruction manual is. If we open the top cover, we could see if anything is jammed.
Sally: Here is the lever.
Janice: Ah yes, I think that's it. I see a piece of paper that is jammed.
Sally: It would be a good idea to get the paper out.
Janice: I don't think we should pull it. The paper might tear and get stuck if you pull it. We may want to turn the roll of paper manually.
Sally: Oh look, there's the knob. If we turn the knob, we can advance the paper.
Janice: OK, that's a good idea. There you go!
Sally: Success! Thank you, Janice!
Janice: No problem!



Let's Practice!

What is wrong with the fax machine?

Instructions: Read the dialogue again. Circle the correct answer.

- 1) The fax machine is ...
 - a. not working
 - b. making a strange noise
 - c. off
- 2) The problem is ...
 - a. a paper jam
 - b. a mechanical problem with the roller
 - c. an error message on the control panel
- 3) To solve the problem, Sally and Janice ...
 - a. used the knob to tear the paper manually
 - b. used the knob to turn the paper roll
 - c. used the lever to turn the machine on



Let's Practice!

Kayla talks about how to deal with a technical problem.

Instructions: Organize the mystery sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1) check / We / there / paper / is / if / a / jam / to / ought

2) to / We / the / turn / of / somehow / may / paper / want / roll

3) want / the / panel / look / control / might / to / You / at

4) be / good / It / out / get / a / idea / would / the / to / paper

5) look / should / instruction / the / for / We / manual





Extension Activity

Write a dialogue solving a technical problem with a piece of equipment.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Select a piece of equipment you use regularly.
- With a partner, write a dialogue. One person asks for help. The other person offers help.
- Make suggestions and say what is advisable.
- Find a solution to the problem.
- Practice your dialogue.
- Change roles.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I ask for help.

☐ ☐

I offer help.

☐ ☐

I make suggestions and say what is advisable.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **fax machine** (noun): equipment used to copy and send documents electronically
e.g. The fax machine seems to be making a strange noise.
- **paper jam** (noun): problem in which a paper cannot be removed from a piece of office equipment
e.g. Perhaps there is a paper jam somewhere.
- **lever** (noun): a device used to turn or move part of a machine
e.g. Here is the lever to turn the paper roll.
- **network** (noun): a series of points of contact that are connected, usually electronically (such as the Internet)
e.g. The network buttons are correct.
- **instruction manual** (noun): document that explains how a machine works
e.g. I'm not sure where the instruction manual is.
- **to be jammed** (expression): to be caught so something won't move
e.g. I see a piece of paper that is jammed.





Learning Points

Conditional Sentences with If Clauses

You use the conditional sentences with modals to talk about what might happen in a certain situation.

There are two parts to the sentence.

One part is the **condition**. The other part is the **result**.

Form:

(If or When + Subject + Present Tense), (Subject + Modal + Object)

In this structure, a comma is placed between the condition and the result.

You can change the two parts of the sentence so that the result comes first.

(Subject + Modal + Object) (If or When + Subject + Present Tense)

In this structure, there is no comma between the result and the condition.

Examples:

- *If we turn the knob, we can advance the paper manually.*
- *It might tear and get stuck if you pull the paper.*
- *If we open the top cover, we could see if anything is jammed.*

Describing a Simple Technical Problem

Here is a list of common technical problems related to office equipment, such as a photocopier, printer or a fax machine:

Something is jammed.

Something is stuck.

There is a (paper) jam.

The control panel is off (not working).

The network buttons are off (not working).

It's making a strange noise.

There is an error message on the control panel.

I can't open the top cover.

The lever is not working.

I'm not sure where the instruction manual is.

